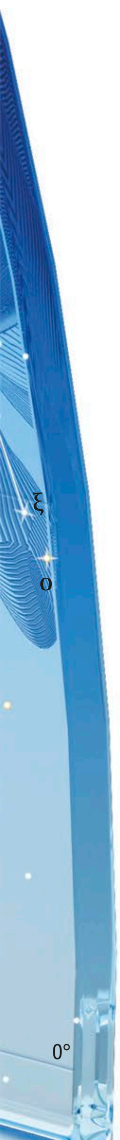

KEY DATA

Size ranking 17

Brightest stars Aldebaran (α) 0.9, Alnath (β) 1.7

Genitive Tauri

Abbreviation Tau

Highest in sky at 10pm December–January

Fully visible 88°N–58°S

CHART 6

MAIN STARS

Aldebaran Alpha (α) Tauri
Red giant
0.9 — 67 light-years

Elnath Beta (β) Tauri
Blue-white giant
1.7 — 134 light-years

Zeta (ζ) Tauri
Binary star
3.0 — 445 light-years

Alcyone Eta (η) Tauri
Blue-white giant in the Pleiades cluster
2.9 — 403 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

Hyades
Open star cluster centered on Theta (θ) Tauri

M45 (Pleiades)
Open star cluster

M1 (Crab Nebula)
Supernova remnant

NGC 1514
Planetary nebula

NGC 1555 (Hind's Variable Nebula)
Reflection nebula

△ **M1**
Popularly called the Crab Nebula, this is the remnant of a supernova that exploded in 1054 and was bright enough to be seen in the daytime. It is about 10 light-years across and still expanding as filaments of gas rush outward from the site of the explosion. A neutron star, the central remnant of the original star is in its center.

ARIES THE RAM

ONE OF THE ZODIAC CONSTELLATIONS, ARIES REPRESENTS A CROUCHING RAM WITH ITS HEAD TURNED TOWARD TAURUS. ITS PATTERN IS RELATIVELY FAINT AND HARD TO IDENTIFY.

According to Greek legend, Aries is the ram whose golden fleece was sought by Jason and the Argonauts. Its most prominent part is a bent line made from three bright stars that mark the ram's head. More than 2,000 years ago Aries contained the vernal equinox, the point where the Sun crosses the celestial equator, south to north. The point, also known as the "First Point of Aries," defines zero hours right ascension. Today, it is in neighboring Pisces.

◁ **NGC 695**
This spiral galaxy, about 450 million light-years away, lies face-on to us. Its spiral arms are not well defined and very loosely wound. Knots of star formation are tangled in a mesh of dust and gas, which gives the whole galaxy a peculiar appearance.

KEY DATA

Size ranking 39

Brightest stars Hamal (α) 2.0, Sheratan (β) 2.7

Genitive Arietis

Abbreviation Ari

Highest in sky at 10pm November–December

Fully visible 90°N–58°S

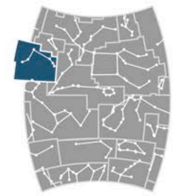

CHART 3

MAIN STARS

Hamal Alpha (α) Arietis
Yellow-orange giant
2.0 — 66 light-years

Sheratan Beta (β) Arietis
Binary star
2.7 — 59 light-years

Mesartim Gamma (γ) Arietis
Binary star
3.9 — 164 light-years

Lambda (λ) Arietis
Binary star
4.8 — 129 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

NGC 695
Spiral galaxy